家計簿

USER GUIDE

Kakeibo

家計簿 kakeibo · household account book

A calm way to save money, from Japan. Plan your month, write down what you spend, and stop at the end of each month to think about it. This app keeps the method and takes away the busywork.

Since 1904

Kakeibo was created by Hani Motoko, Japan's first woman journalist, as a simple notebook for managing a household. Over a century later the idea still works because it isn't about apps or charts: it's about *noticing*. Writing a spend down, choosing what kind it is, and looking back at the month changes how you spend.

Four questions

収入	How much money do I have?
貯金	How much do I want to save?

支出 How much am I spending?

改善 How can I do better?

Four pillars

Every spend goes into one pillar. When you're not sure, ask: *do I need it, or do I want it?*

生活

Needs

seikatsu · daily life

嗜好

Wants

shikō · taste, pleasure

文化

Culture

bunka · culture

予想外

Unexpected

yosōgai · the unexpected

One month, three steps

計画

Plan

Income, fixed costs, and what you'll save first.

記録

Log

Each spend in three taps: amount, pillar, save.

反省

Reflect

What went well, and one thing to change next month.

What this app does for you

- Works out what's left to spend, and how much a day keeps you on track.
- Shows each pillar filling up, and tells you kindly when you go over.
- Reminds you to log, to check in each week and to reflect each month, if you want it to.
- Keeps everything on your phone: no account, no internet, no ads, with weekly backups.

CHAPTER 1

家計簿 kakeibo · household account book

Welcome to Kakeibo

Kakeibo (kah-keh-boh) is a Japanese way of keeping a household account book, first published in 1904. You plan your month, write down what you spend, and stop at the end of each month to think about it. That small, regular pause is what helps people save.

This app keeps the method and removes the busywork. It does the sums for you, takes three taps to log a spend, reminds you when it's time to check in, and keeps everything on your phone: no account, no internet, no ads.

The four questions

1. How much money do I have?
2. How much do I want to save?
3. How much am I spending?
4. How can I do better?

The four pillars

- **Needs**: what you can't do without, such as groceries, bus fares and electricity.
- **Wants**: nice to have, such as eating out, shopping and takeaway.
- **Culture**: books, a course, a concert, a museum.
- **Unexpected**: surprises, such as a repair, a doctor's visit or a gift you didn't plan.

> **Tip** When you're not sure which pillar, ask: *do I need it, or do I want it?*



The welcome tour



The four pillars



Plan, log, reflect

CHAPTER 2

始め hajime · the beginning

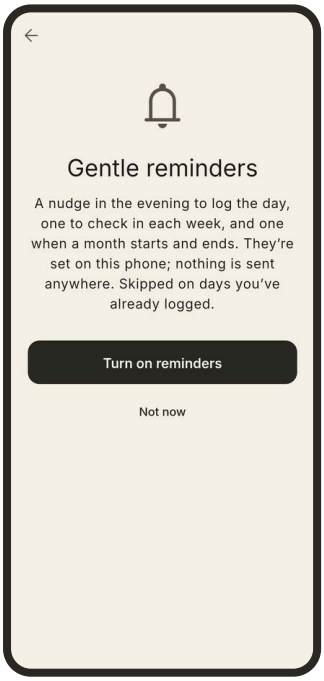
Getting started

The first time you open Kakeibo, a five-card tour explains the method. Swipe or tap **Next**; **Skip** is always at the top right. You can watch it again any time from **Settings → Help → Replay guide**.

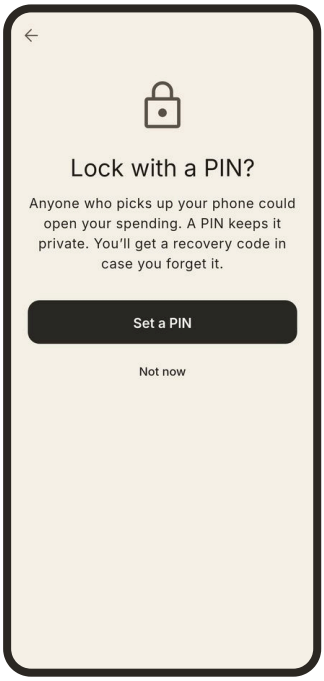
After the tour, three quick steps:

1. **A few settings.** Amounts show in Sri Lankan Rupees as **Rs 12,500.00**. Choose the day your month starts: day 1 for calendar months, or your salary day.
2. **Reminders.** Turn on gentle reminders, or choose Not now. You can change this later.
3. **PIN.** Protect the app with a PIN, or set one up later in Settings.

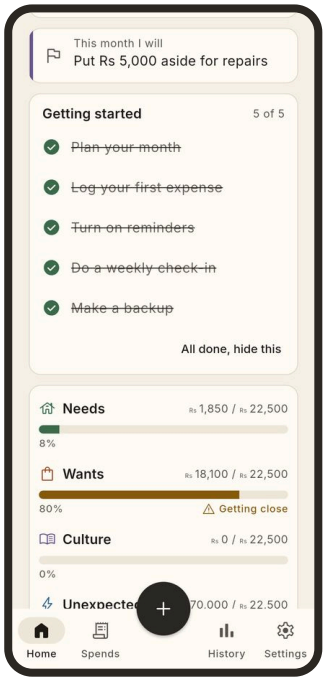
Then the app takes you straight to planning your first month. On Home, a **Getting started** list shows five first steps and ticks them off as you go.



Reminders, explained first



An optional PIN



The Getting started list

> **Tip** The first time you open each main screen, a few short tips point out the important controls. Tap anywhere to move on; each one appears only once.

CHAPTER 3

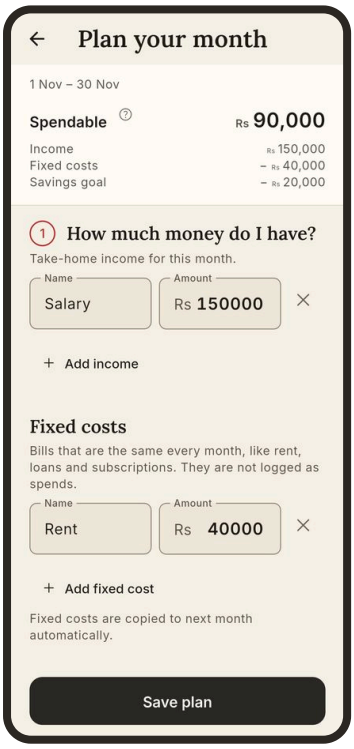
計画 keikaku · plan

Plan your month

Planning takes a minute at the start of each month. On Home tap **Plan** (or **Edit plan** later).

1. **Income**: what you'll take home this month, for example a salary of 150,000. Tap **Add income** for more than one.
2. **Fixed costs**: bills that are the same every month, like rent of 40,000. They're copied to next month automatically, and you don't log them as spends.
3. **Savings goal**: what you'll save first, for example 20,000.
4. **Split across the four pillars** (optional): a budget for each, or tap **Split evenly**.
5. Tap **Start my month** (or **Save plan**).

The top of the screen shows **Spendable** as you type: income minus fixed costs minus savings. Tap **(?)** next to it for the sum in words.



Plan your month

Save first

Once your month is planned, Home asks you to put your savings aside before you spend. Move the money to a savings account, then tap **Done**. The savings ring gets a red “saved” stamp.

CHAPTER 4

記録 kiroku · record

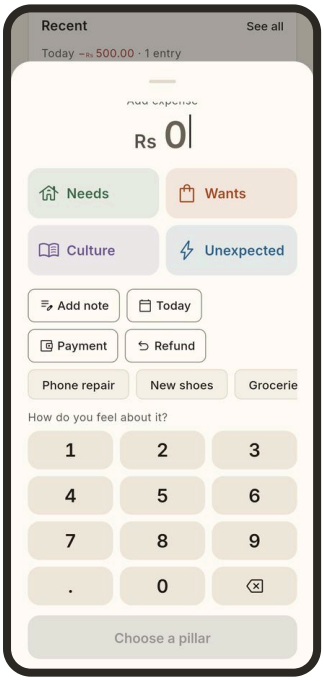
Log a spend

Tap the round **+** button at the bottom of any main screen.

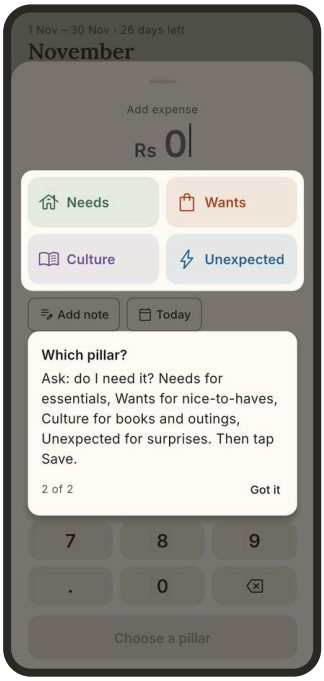
1. Type the amount on the number pad. No keyboard needed.
2. Tap a pillar: Needs, Wants, Culture or Unexpected.
3. Tap **Save**. A message confirms it, with **Undo** for 4 seconds.

Optional extras, all one tap away:

- **Add note**: what it was for. Notes you use often appear as one-tap suggestions.
- **Today**: change the date to an earlier day this month.
- **Payment**: Cash, Card, Bank transfer or LankaQR.
- **How do you feel about it?** Worth it, Neutral or Regret. Your month-end reflection lists the Worth it and Regret spends.



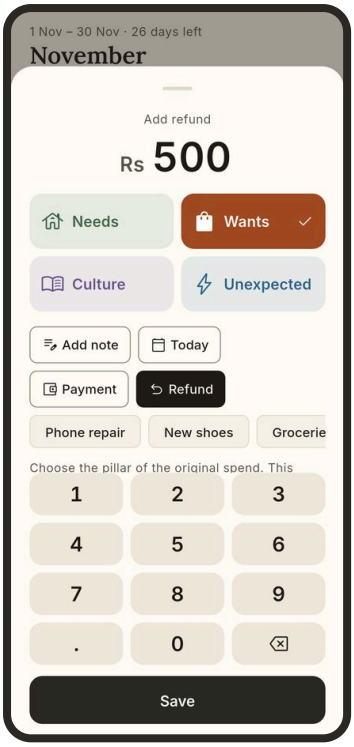
Quick add



Which pillar?

Log a refund

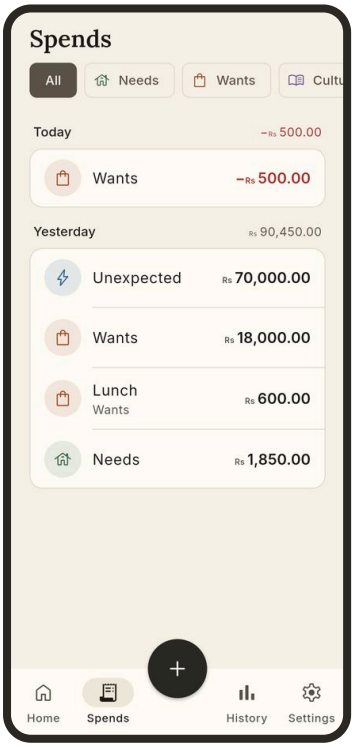
Got money back? Tap **+**, type the amount, tap **Refund**, choose the pillar of the original spend and **Save**. The refund lowers that pillar's total.



Adding a refund

Fix or delete a spend

Open **Spends**. Tap a spend to change it. Swipe it to the left, or press and hold it, to delete it. There's always an **Undo**. Use the pillar chips at the top to see one pillar at a time.



Spends, grouped by day

CHAPTER 5

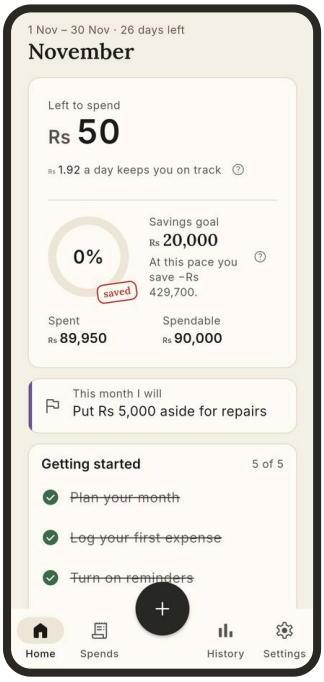
今月 kongetsu · this month

Your Home screen

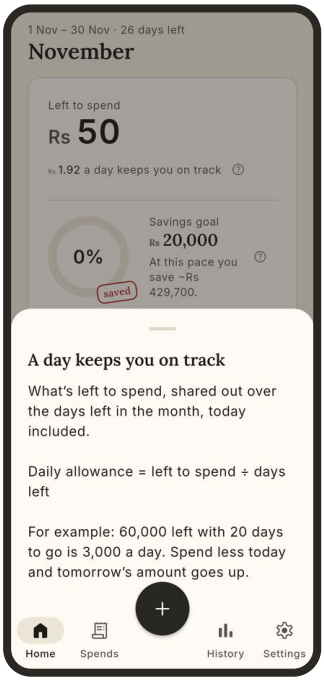
Home answers the question *how am I doing this month?*

- **Left to spend**: spendable money minus what you've spent so far.
- **… a day keeps you on track**: what's left, shared over the days left. Spend less today and tomorrow's amount goes up.
- **The savings ring**: from day 4, what you'd save if you kept spending at this pace. If you go over budget, it shows how much of your goal is still safe.
- **Pillar bars**: each fills as you spend against its budget. Amber means close, red means over, always with a word and an icon too. Tap a bar to see its spends.
- **Recent**: today's total and your last five spends.
- **Kakeibo tip**: a short tip each day. Hide it with **Hide tips**.

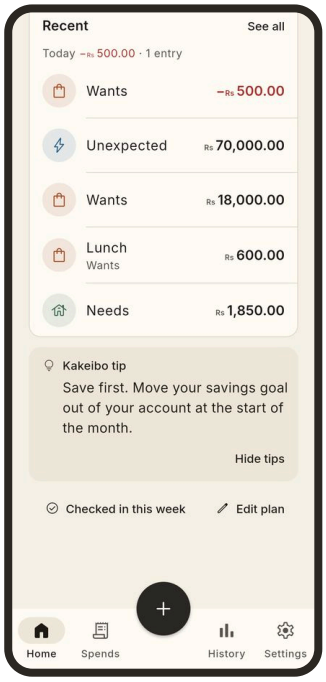
> **Tip** Tap **(?)** next to a number to see, in plain words, how it's worked out.



Left to spend and the savings ring



(?) explains a number



Recent spends and a tip

If you spend more than planned, Home tells you honestly and kindly: how far over you are, and what that does to your savings. It's never a scolding.

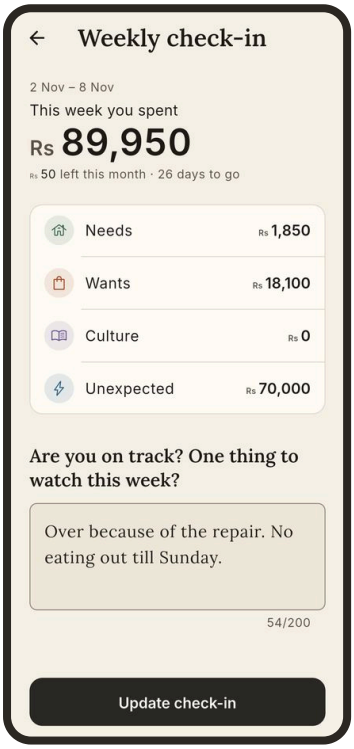
CHAPTER 6

週 shū · week

Weekly check-in

Once a week, take a minute to look back. Home suggests it on the last two days of each week, and you can open it any time from **Weekly check-in** under Recent.

It shows what you spent this week in each pillar and how much is left for the month, then asks: *are you on track? One thing to watch this week?* Write a line and tap **Save check-in**.



Weekly check-in

Tip Choose the day your week starts in **Settings → Routine → Week starts on**.

CHAPTER 7

反省 hansei · reflection

Reflect at the end of the month

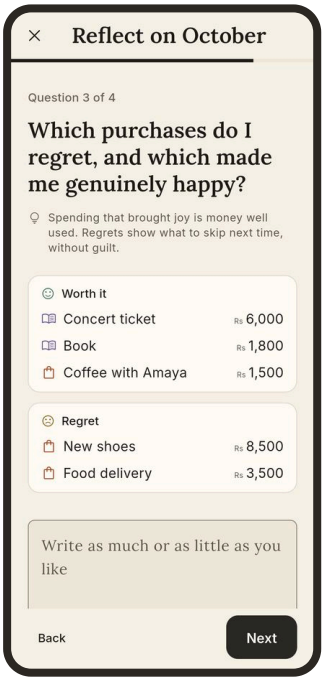
When a month ends, a new one starts by itself, so you can keep logging. The reflection for the month that ended opens once on its own; after that it waits as a card on Home.

1. **The month in numbers**: what you saved compared with your goal, and each pillar's spending. If you missed the goal, it shows by how much and suggests (never forces) a gentler goal for next month.
2. **The four questions**, one per page. Write as much or as little as you like. Your first time, each question explains why it matters.
3. **Did I keep last month's improvement?** Yes, Partly or No.
4. **One thing to change next month.** Tap **Finish**: it appears on Home all next month as "This month I will...".

Your answers are saved as you go, so closing the reflection loses nothing.



One question per page



Worth it and Regret



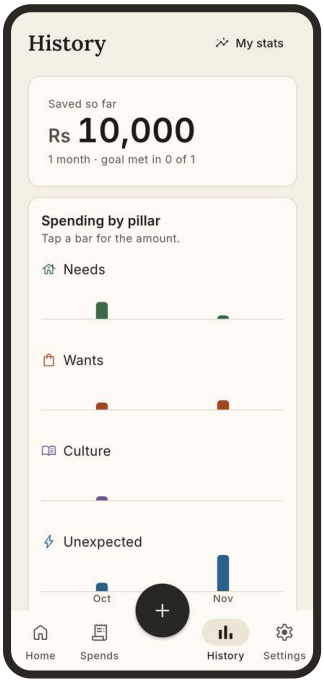
One thing to change

CHAPTER 8

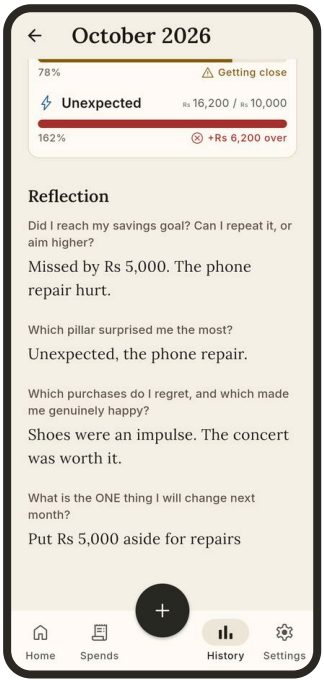
履歴 rireki · a record of the past

History and My stats

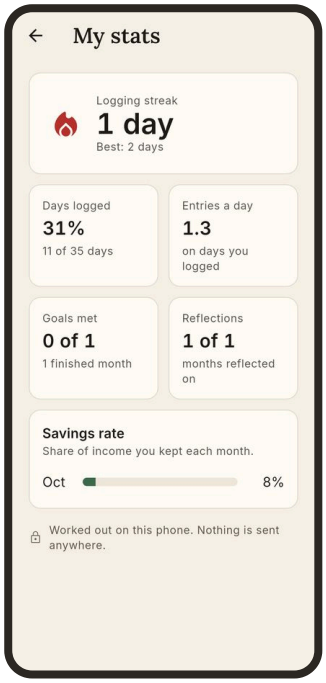
History shows how far you've come: what you've saved so far, a savings line by month, spending by pillar over the last six months, and a card for every finished month. Tap a bar for its amount. Tap a month to see its totals and read your reflection.



History



A month and its reflection



My stats

My stats (top right of History) shows your logging streak, how many days you've logged, goals met, reflections done and your savings rate. It's worked out on your phone.

CHAPTER 9

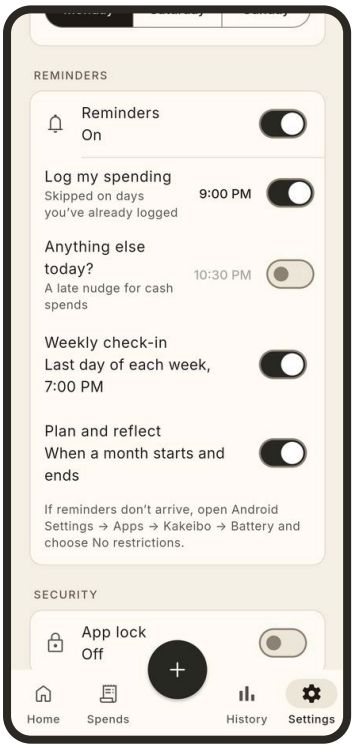
お知らせ oshirase · a gentle notice

Reminders

Open **Settings → Reminders** and turn them on. The app explains what they're for before Android asks for permission.

- **Log my spending**: each evening (9:00 PM unless you change it). Skipped on days you've already logged.
- **Anything else today?**: an optional late nudge for cash spends.
- **Weekly check-in**: on the last day of each week.
- **Plan and reflect**: when a month starts and ends.

> **Tip** If reminders don't arrive, open **Android Settings → Apps → Kakeibo → Battery** and choose **No restrictions**. If you turn notifications off, the same prompts appear as cards on Home.



Routine and Reminders

CHAPTER 10

保存 hozon · keeping safe

Back up your data

Everything is on your phone, with no cloud copy. If the phone is lost or reset, **a backup file is the only copy**. Please turn on the weekly backup.

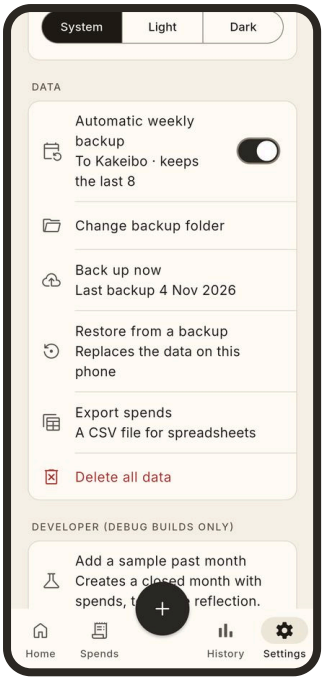
Automatic weekly backup

1. Open **Settings → Data** and turn on **Automatic weekly backup**.
2. Choose a folder. Android won't allow the Download folder itself, so open Download, create a folder called **Kakeibo** and choose that.
3. Tap **Use this folder**, then **Allow**.

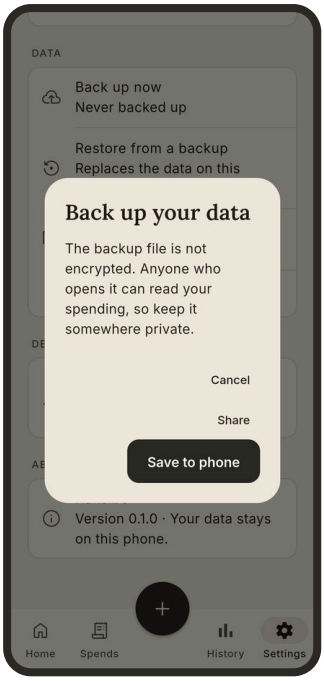
Kakeibo backs up straight away and then once a week when you open it, keeping the newest 8 files. Home reminds you if there's been no backup for 14 days.

Back up now, restore, export

- **Back up now**: save a backup to your phone or share it to Google Drive or email. The file isn't encrypted, so keep it private.
- **Restore from a backup**: choose a Kakeibo backup file. The app shows what's in it and keeps a safety copy of your current data, then replaces everything.
- **Export spends**: a CSV file of every spend for a spreadsheet.
- **Delete all data**: asks twice before deleting everything.



Settings → Data



Back up now

Moving to a new phone

1. On the old phone, **Back up now** and put the file somewhere you can reach (Google Drive, email, or a USB cable).
2. On the new phone, install Kakeibo and use **Restore from a backup**.

CHAPTER 11

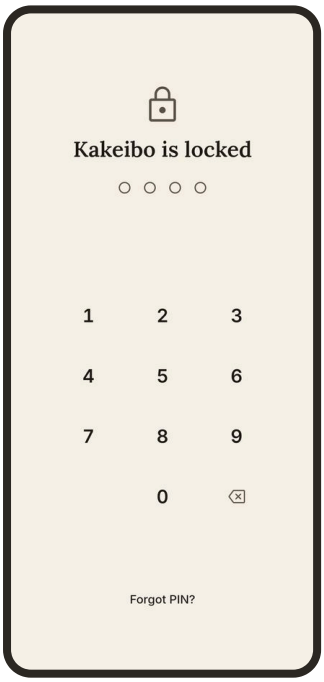
鍵 kagi · key

Lock the app with a PIN

Settings → Security → App lock asks for a 4 to 6 digit PIN when Kakeibo opens.

1. Choose a PIN and type it again.
2. Kakeibo shows a 12-character **recovery code**. Write it down and keep it away from the phone. It's shown only once.
3. Type the code back to confirm you have it.

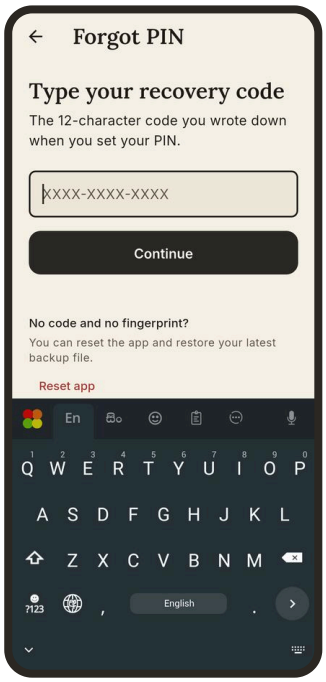
- **Unlock with fingerprint**, if your phone has one.
- **Lock again after**: at once, after 1 minute or after 5 minutes away.
- After 5 wrong PINs the app makes you wait, longer each time.
- **Forgot PIN?** on the lock screen: type your recovery code and set a new PIN. Without the code or fingerprint, the only way in is **Reset app**, which deletes everything, after which you can restore a backup.



The lock screen



Too many tries



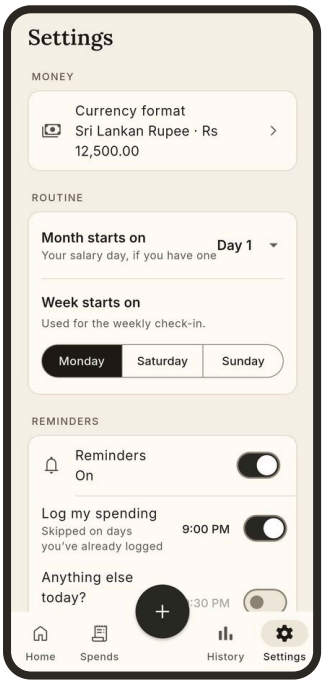
Forgot PIN

CHAPTER 12

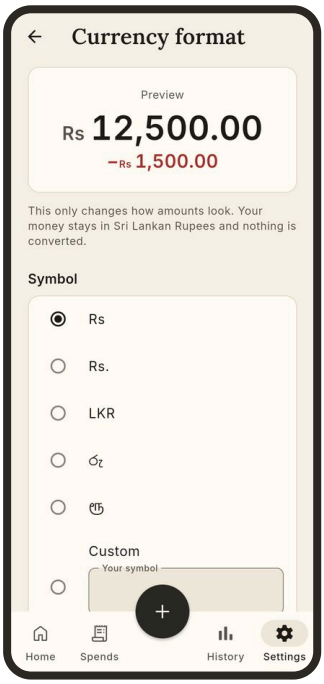
設定 settei · settings

Settings at a glance

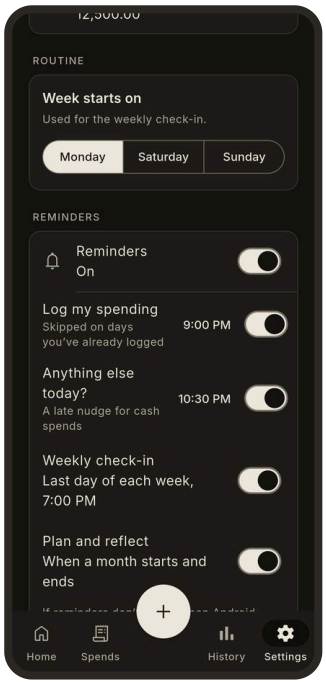
- **Currency format**: Rs, Rs., LKR, ৳, ৲ or your own; before or after the number; with or without a space. Your money always stays in Sri Lankan Rupees.
- **Routine**: the day your month starts and the day your week starts.
- **Reminders**, **Security** and **Data**: see the chapters above.
- **Theme**: System, Light or Dark.
- **Help**: the Help Center, Replay guide, tip of the day and Export diagnostics.



Settings



Currency format



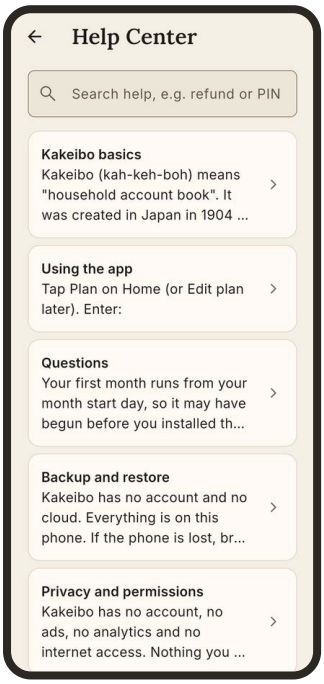
Dark theme

CHAPTER 13

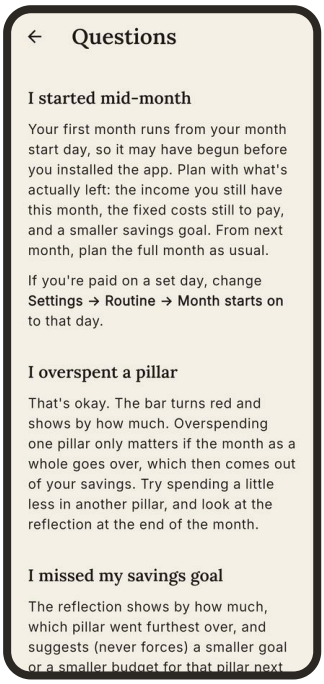
助け tasuke · help

Help Center and questions

Settings → Help → Help Center has short articles on Kakeibo basics, using the app, backups and privacy, plus answers to common questions. Search for any word, like “refund” or “PIN”. It works without internet.



Help Center



Questions

Quick answers

- **I started mid-month.** Plan with what's actually left this month: income still to come, fixed costs still to pay, and a smaller savings goal.
- **I overspent a pillar.** That's okay. It only matters if the whole month goes over, which then comes out of your savings.
- **I missed my savings goal.** Your reflection shows why and suggests a gentler goal.
- **I didn't do last month's reflection.** Logging is never blocked; the reflection waits on Home.
- **Which pillar is a gift / a phone bill / Netflix?** See Kakeibo basics in the Help Center. Choose once and stay consistent.

CHAPTER 14

秘密 himitsu · private

Privacy

Kakeibo has no account, no ads, no analytics and no internet access. Nothing you enter leaves your phone unless you share a backup or export yourself.

- Your PIN is never stored, only a scrambled version of it.
- Notifications are only for the reminders you turn on.
- Fingerprint is only used if you turn on fingerprint unlock.
- The app can only read and write the one backup folder you choose.
- If something goes wrong, an error log is kept on the phone. **Settings → Help → Export diagnostics** lets you share it if you choose.